

OpenAI API Mistakes

1. **Wrong API endpoint** - Initially tried to use Chat Completions API instead of the new Responses API
2. **Invalid temperature parameter** - Tried adding `temperature` which isn't supported in Responses API
3. **Missing reasoning parameter** - Didn't know GPT-5 models require `reasoning: { effort: "medium" }`
4. **Low token limits** - GPT-5 models need 1000+ `max_output_tokens` or they return empty output
5. **Response parsing confusion** - Took time to realize GPT-4.1 returns `message.content[0].text` while GPT-5 returns `output`

Form/Select Component Issues

6. **defaultValue vs value** - Used `defaultValue={field.value}` on Select components, which prevented programmatic updates (cURL import) from showing in UI. Should have been `value={field.value || default}`
7. **Uncontrolled to controlled warnings** - Select components changing from uncontrolled to controlled due to undefined values

Keyboard Shortcut Problems

8. **Blocking paste in inputs** - Ctrl+V for pasting nodes was preventing users from pasting text into input/textarea fields
9. **Blocking copy in inputs** - Same issue with Ctrl+C
10. **No input detection** - Forgot to check if `target.tagName === 'INPUT' || 'TEXTAREA'` before triggering shortcuts

Paste/Clipboard UX Issues

11. **autoFocus didn't work** - Added `autoFocus` attribute to textarea but dialog animation interfered
12. **Manual focus timing** - Needed `useEffect` with `setTimeout(100ms)` to properly focus after dialog opens
13. **Still couldn't paste** - Even with focus, users couldn't paste from clipboard (browser security/focus issues)
14. **Missing clipboard button** - Had to add explicit "Paste from Clipboard" button using `navigator.clipboard.readText()`

Properties Panel UX Mistakes

15. **Aggressive auto-expand** - Panel auto-expanded on every node selection change instead of only when going from "no selection" to "new selection"
16. **No delete button** - User had no obvious way to delete nodes - only keyboard shortcut which was easy to miss

HTML/CSS Violations

17. **Nesting violations** - Used `<div>` inside `<p>` tags in FormDescription, causing scroll issues
18. **Should have used spans** - Fixed by using `<span className="block">` instead

Security Vulnerabilities

19. **Command injection risk** - Used `exec()` for git commands with unsanitized workflow names
20. **Fixed with spawn** - Switched to `child_process.spawn` with argument arrays

Tool Node Implementation

21. **No JSON body field** - Initially only had generic "parameters" field, needed explicit JSON body for POST/PUT requests
22. **cURL parser edge cases** - Had to handle:
 - Line continuations (backslash on Unix, caret on Windows)
 - Multiple `-d` flags that need concatenation
 - Quoted strings with escape sequences
 - Basic auth base64 decoding

Architecture Decisions That Required Iteration

23. **Backward compatibility** - Had to maintain old `parameters` field while adding new `body` field
24. **Deep variable substitution** - First attempt only did shallow replacement, had to add recursive JSON traversal
25. **Auto-save debouncing** - Initially saved too frequently, causing performance issues

Things That Worked First Try

- PostgreSQL migration with versioning
- React Flow canvas integration
- Zustand state management
- Variable substitution syntax design
- Google Sheets integration
- Status badge system